Before You Judge Someone

What did this person do — and what have I added?

READING

Epictetus, *Enchiridion* 45 and 43. The first passage separates description from judgments that need further knowledge. The second acknowledges a brother's injustice while recalling their relationship. A fuller perspective must be true and relevant; it need not excuse misconduct or restore trust.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Announce on your Substack with the question and reading links. Ask for anonymous examples. Members may use the fictional case instead of a personal conflict.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Practice · 20	Discuss · 40	Close · 10
Ground rules; no identifying details	Aloud, together	A colleague misses a deadline	The questions below	One takeaway each

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. A colleague misses an agreed deadline. What is established, and what remains uncertain?
2. When does a judgment about conduct become a verdict about the whole person?
3. What other true and relevant perspective would help you understand this conflict fairly?
4. Can a justified grievance acquire an additional verdict that payback would be good?
5. What remains owed to a fellow human being when an adverse judgment is justified?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Separate conduct from verdict. When judging someone, describe the conduct, name the further conclusion, and examine its grounds. Recall a relevant relationship or shared humanity without inventing a reassuring motive. Keep warranted criticism; revise what exceeds the evidence.

FACILITATOR'S MOVE

"Which judgment are we examining?" Distinguish misconduct, motive, personal worth, and payback. Understanding a person does not settle what response justice requires.

NOTES